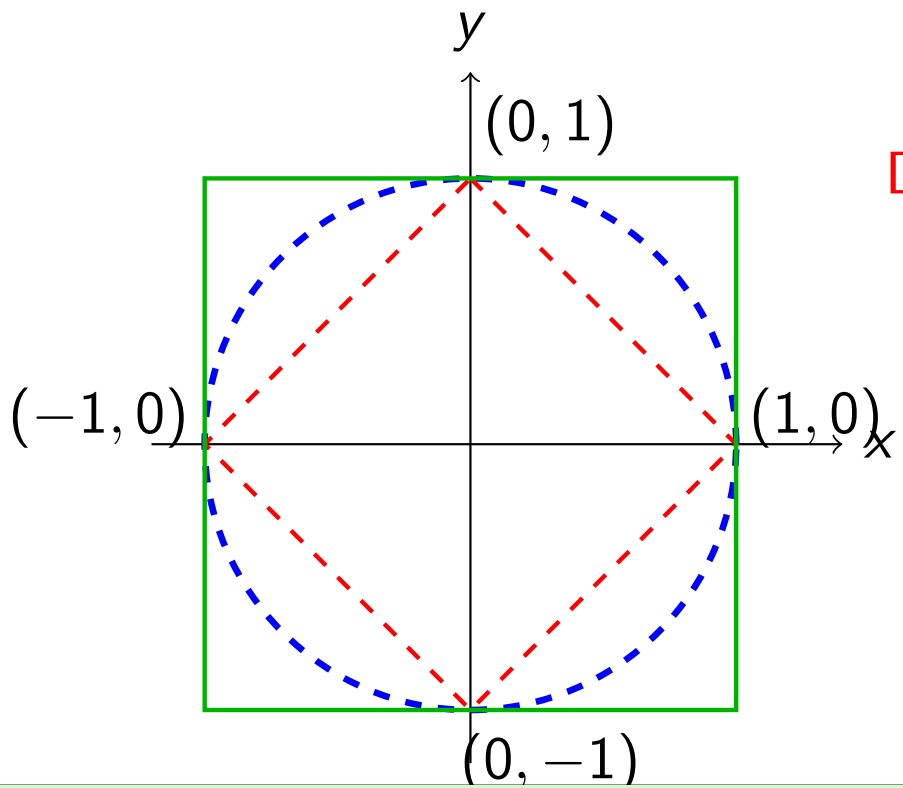
MA385 Part 4: Linear Algebra 2

4.1: Vector Norms

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Diamond: $\|x\|_1 \leq 1$

Circle: $\|x\|_2 \leq 1$

Square: $\|x\|_\infty \leq 1$

1. Outline Section 4.1

1. Introduction
2. Three vector norms
3. $\|\cdot\|_\infty$ is a norm on $\mathbb{R}^n$
4. $\|\cdot\|_2$ is a norm on $\mathbb{R}^n$
   - Cauchy-Schwarz
   - Applying C-S
5. Exercises

For more, see Section 2.7 of Suli and Mayers:
https://ebookcentral.proquest.com/lib/nuig/reader.action?docID=221072&ppg=51&c=UERG

This is the final section of MA385. Really, it is a direct continuation of Section 3 – and much of the material is from the same chapter as Section 3 in the text-book (though we'll also take some material from Chapter 5).

2. Introduction

At its heart, this section is concerned with the task of bounding the eigenvalues and singular values of a matrix. Our motivation comes from doing an error analysis for LU-factorization. However, the applications are far more general than that.

But for now, we'll just note that all computer implementations of algorithms that involve floating-point numbers (roughly, finite decimal approximations of real numbers) contain errors due to round-off error.

It transpires that computer implementations of LU-factorization, and related methods, lead to these round-off errors being greatly magnified: and we want to understand why.

2. Introduction

You might remember from earlier sections of the course that we had to assume functions where well-behaved in the sense that

$$\frac{|f(x) - f(y)|}{|x - y|} \leq L,$$

for some number L, so that our numerical schemes (e.g., fixed point iteration, Euler's method, etc) would work. If a function *doesn't* satisfy a condition like this, we say it is "**ill-conditioned**". One of the consequences is that a small error in the inputs gives a large error in the outputs.

We'd like to be able to express similar ideas about matrices: that $A(u - v) = Au - Av$ is not too "*large*" compared to $u - v$. To do this we used the notion of a "**norm**" to describing the relatives sizes of the vectors $\mathbf{u}$ and $A\mathbf{u}$.

3. Three vector norms

Definition 4.1.1

Let $\mathbb{R}^n$ be all the vectors of length n of real numbers. The function $\|\cdot\|$ is called a **norm** of $\mathbb{R}^n$ if, for all $u, v \in \mathbb{R}^n$

1. $\|v\| \geq 0$,
2. $\|v\| = 0$ if and only if $v = 0$.
3. $\|\lambda v\| = |\lambda|\|v\|$ for any $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$,
4. $\|u + v\| \leq \|u\| + \|v\|$ (triangle inequality).

This is quite like **absolute value** function of real number, which tell us the size of a number (ignoring its sign).

Norms of vectors are similar: they quantify the *size* of the vector. But there are possible such functions.

Definition 4.1.2

Let $\mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^n$: $\mathbf{v} = (v_1, v_2, \ldots, v_{n-1}, v_n)^T$.

(i) The 1-*norm* (a.k.a. the *Taxi cab* norm) is

$$\|v\|_1 = \sum_{i=1}^{n} |v_i|.$$

(ii) The 2-*norm* (a.k.a. the *Euclidean norm*)

$$\|v\|_2 = \left(\sum_{i=1}^{n} v_i^2 \right)^{1/2}.$$

Note, if $\mathbf{v}$ is a vector in $\mathbb{R}^n$, then

$$\mathbf{v}^T\mathbf{v} = v_1^2 + v_2^2 + \cdots + v_n^2 = \|\mathbf{v}\|_2^2.$$

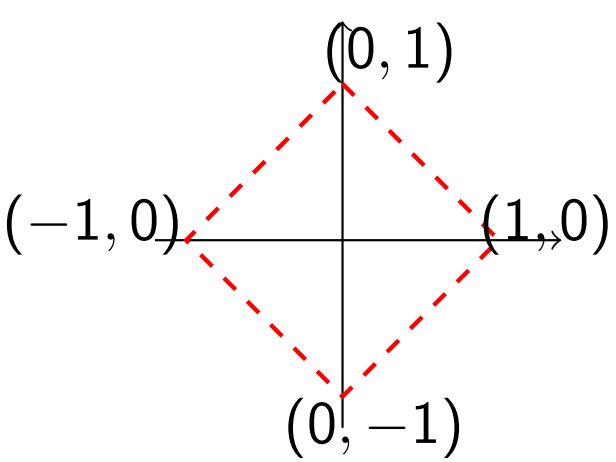
(iii) The ∞-*norm* (a.k.a. the max-*norm*) $\|v\|_\infty = \max_{i=1}^{n} |v_i|$.

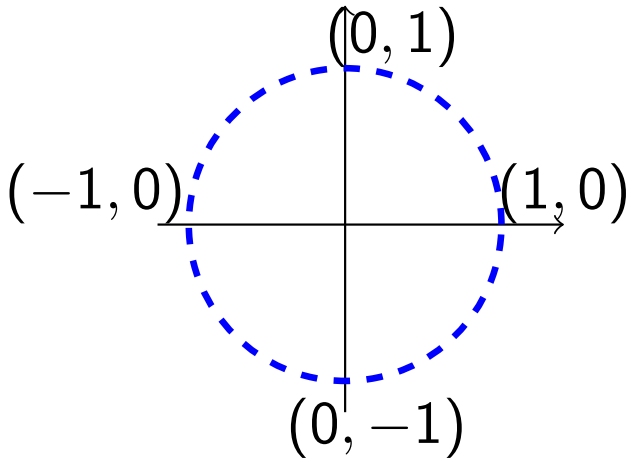
3. Three vector norms

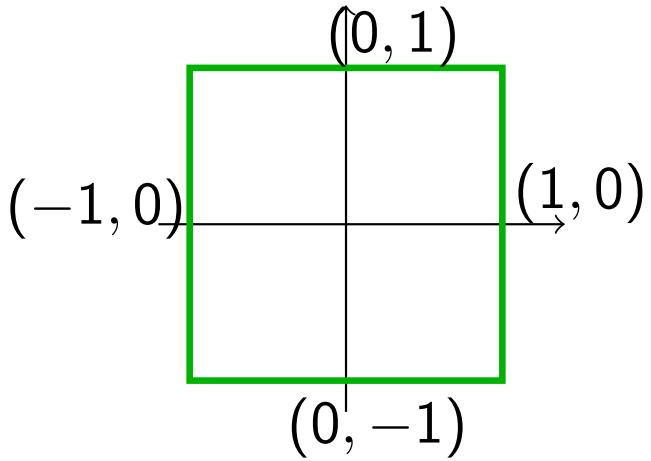
Example: Compute the 1-, 2- and ∞-norm of $\mathbf{v} = (-2, 4, -4)^T$

3. Three vector norms

The unit balls in $\mathbb{R}^2$ given by $\|\cdot\|_1$ (top left), $\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 = \sqrt{x_1^2 + x_2^2} = 1$ (top right), and $\|\cdot\|_\infty$.







3. Three vector norms

It is easy to show that $\|\cdot\|_1$ and $\|\cdot\|_\infty$ are norms (see next slide).

And it is not hard to show that $\|\cdot\|_2$ satisfies conditions (1), (2) and (3) of Definition 4.1.1.
It takes a little bit of effort to show that $\|\cdot\|_2$ satisfies the triangle inequality; so we'll do that with care.

4. $\|\cdot\|_\infty$ is a norm on $\mathbb{R}^n$

As mentioned, it takes a little effort to show that $\|\cdot\|_2$ is indeed a norm on $\mathbb{R}^2$; in particular to show that it satisfies the triangle inequality, we need the Cauchy-Schwarz inequality.

Lemma (Cauchy-Schwarz)

$$|\sum_{i=1}^{n} u_i v_i| \leq \|\mathbf{u}\|_2 \|\mathbf{v}\|_2, \qquad \forall \mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^n.$$

Idea: $0 \leq \|\lambda u + v\|_2^2$.

Example: Pick two vectors in $\mathbb{R}^3$ and convince yourself they satisfy the Cauchy-Schwarz Inequality.

Now can now apply Cauchy-Schwatz to show that

$$\|\mathbf{u}+\mathbf{v}\|_2 \leq \|\mathbf{u}\|_2 + \|\mathbf{v}\|_2.$$

This is because

$$\begin{aligned}
\|u+v\|_2^2 &= (u+v)^T(u+v) \\
&= u^Tu + 2u^Tv + v^Tv \\
&\leq u^Tu + 2|u^Tv| + v^Tv \quad \text{(by the triangle-inequality)} \\
&\leq u^Tu + 2\|u\|\|v\| + v^Tv \quad \text{(by Cauchy-Schwarz)} \\
&= (\|u\| + \|v\|)^2.
\end{aligned}$$

It follows directly that

Corollary

$\|\cdot\|_2$ is a norm.

6. Exercises

Exercise 4.1.1

Show that, for any vector $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n$, $\|\mathbf{x}\|_\infty \leq \|\mathbf{x}\|_2$ and $\|\mathbf{x}\|_2^2 \leq \|\mathbf{x}\|_1 \|\mathbf{x}\|_\infty$. For each of these inequalities, give an example for which the equality holds. Deduce that $\|\mathbf{x}\|_\infty \leq \|\mathbf{x}\|_2 \leq \|\mathbf{x}\|_1$.

Exercise 4.1.2

Show that if $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$, then $\|\mathbf{x}\|_1 \leq n\|\mathbf{x}\|_\infty$ and that $\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 \leq \sqrt{n}\|\mathbf{x}\|_\infty$.